



The Illustrations menu

Access the graphical elements from the Ribbon (**Insert > Illustrations**). You have options such as Picture, Clip Art, Shapes, and SmartArt. Alternatively, you can place any of these categories in the Quick Access Toolbar above the Ribbon for easy one-click access.

8.1 The Shapes Group

The shapes menu has all the basic shapes you would normally find in earlier versions of Excel. Apart from Lines, Basic Shapes, Block Arrows, Flowchart, Callouts, and Star Banners, there is a Recently Used Shapes option that intelligently stores all the shapes you recently used, for quick access. These shapes can be easily drawn and formatted too.

8.2 Drawing Basic Shapes

Drawing basic shapes is easy! Go to **Insert > Shapes** and then choose the shape you want to select. Next, drag the cursor diagonally across the worksheet to create the shape in the size you want.

If you want to maintain the horizontal or vertical aspect ratio of the shape while enlarging or reducing its size, you can hold down [Ctrl] while doing so. Alternatively, holding down the [Ctrl] + [Shift] keys will maintain both the horizontal and vertical aspect ratios of the shape you are drawing.

Under **Shapes > Recently Used Shapes**, there is a shape called Scribble. What this does is, it allows you to create custom shapes of your choice. So if you want to doodle or create a shape for your signature, this is the tool you should use. All the regular formatting settings apply to this shape, so you can further stylise your creative genius!